

LABORATORY ACTIVITY

SWOT Analysis of My Technopreneurial Project

Project/Business Name: TrustHome_PH

One Sentence Description: A verified rental marketplace with a fairness scored, publicly curated bank acquired property catalog that replaces scam prone informal rental channels in the Philippines.

Team Members: Andresa, Rev Andrei; Carillo, Christopher Andrei; Prades, Justine James; Laurente, Vien Melvic; Solpico, Robert

SWOT Matrix

STRENGTHS (Internal, Helpful)	WEAKNESSES (Internal, Harmful)
• Self contained system design, with no reliance on bank partnerships, payment gateways, or government approval for the MVP to function. • Three real computational cores: automatic conflict detection for overlapping booking dates, a weighted trust and fairness score with an anti gaming rule, and a loan amortization calculator, not just a CRUD listings app. • Honest, defensible scope: explicitly states it is not a legal title search and does not custody funds, avoiding promises the team can't back. • Clear direct to consumer monetization on both sides (owner verification badge or boost, renter saved search subscription) that doesn't depend on a second party paying first.	• Document review only filters casual fraud (fake IDs, stolen photos). It cannot catch a forged land title, so a sophisticated scam could still get through. • No custodial fund handling means the platform can't literally prevent a deposit loss. Protection comes after the fact, through a public dispute flag, not before it. • Launch depends on an initial seeded batch of listings to demo value before real renters and owners arrive, a bootstrap step the team must actively manage. • The bank acquired catalog depends on manually curating several separate bank pages (BDO, Landbank, PNB, Metrobank, DBP) on a fixed cadence, which takes real ongoing effort to sustain.
OPPORTUNITIES (External, Helpful)	THREATS (External, Harmful)
• Renters and buyers currently rely on scam prone informal channels (Facebook Marketplace, group chats), a large, underserved market used to a workaround, not a solution. • No existing PH platform combines reviewed listings, a computed trust score, a dispute linked accountability trail, and a bank foreclosure catalog in one place (a gap versus Lamudi, OLX, and Rentpad). • Steady, recurring bank foreclosure and ROPA inventory in the Philippines creates ongoing demand for one aggregated, easy to browse catalog with a built in loan calculator. • Room for future upside, such as real estate agency lead fees or a bank partnership for premium placement, without needing either to exist at launch.	• Established players (Lamudi, OLX, Facebook Marketplace, Rentpad, Airbnb) could copy the verification or trust score idea once it's proven, eroding TrustHome's edge. • Banks could restructure, paywall, or frequently change the format of their ROPA and Acquired Assets pages, disrupting the curation pipeline the catalog depends on. • A scam that slips past document review despite the stated limitation could damage user trust, especially if users don't fully register the 'not a title search' disclaimer. • Willingness to pay for badges or alerts is unproven before launch, since core browsing stays free, so monetized features carry real conversion risk.

TOWS Strategy Table

Strategy Type	Your Team's Strategy Statement(s)
SO (Strengths + Opportunities)	Use the scam prone informal channel problem (Opportunity) together with the self contained verification and trust score system (Strength) to market TrustHome as the first computationally verified alternative to Facebook Marketplace groups, directly filling the gap versus Lamudi,

	OLX, and Rentpad.
WO (Weaknesses + Opportunities)	Use the clear competitive gap (Opportunity) to justify recruiting a small number of agency or broker sourced listings for the launch city, easing the seeded listings bootstrap weakness while still proving demand before requiring anyone's cooperation.
ST (Strengths + Threats)	Continuously highlight the three real computations and the public, permanent dispute flag accountability trail (Strength) to build an early trust and reputation edge before Lamudi, Rentpad, or others can copy the feature (Threat).
WT (Weaknesses + Threats)	Build the bank catalog curation process with a manual update fallback rather than pure automated scraping, so a bank page redesign (Threat) doesn't break the catalog, and be upfront that listings are 'document reviewed, not title verified' (Weakness) so trust isn't overpromised and then broken by a scam that slips through (Threat).

Guide Questions

1. Which single Strength gives your project the biggest competitive edge, and why?

The three genuine computations: automatic conflict detection, the weighted trust and fairness score, and the loan calculator. Together they prove TrustHome isn't 'just a CRUD listings app,' which is the exact objection panels raise against student marketplace projects.

2. Which Weakness poses the greatest risk to your project's success, and how will you address it?

Not custodialing funds means the platform cannot literally stop a deposit scam in progress. This is addressed by leaning on the public, permanent dispute flag consequence system so a bad actor has something real to lose, and by stating the limitation openly instead of implying a guarantee the team can't back.

3. Which Opportunity is most time sensitive (must be acted on soon before it disappears)?

The market gap versus existing players (Lamudi, OLX, Rentpad, Airbnb). Any of them could add a trust score or a bank foreclosure catalog at any time, so being first to market with the accountability trail matters now, not later.

4. Which Threat is most likely to occur, and what is your contingency plan?

Banks changing the format or availability of their ROPA and Acquired Assets pages. Contingency: keep the catalog curation process partly manual rather than fully automated scraping, so a page redesign only slows an update instead of breaking the catalog entirely.

Reflection

The most useful insight from this SWOT was realizing that our biggest defense against being dismissed as 'just another listings app' isn't more features. It's naming our real computations out loud (conflict detection, trust scoring, loan calculation) and being upfront about what we deliberately chose not to build, like fund custody and title verification. Being honest about the limits actually made the pitch feel stronger, not weaker.